

RFP Internal Review Process & Color Team Involvement

A structured, stage-gate approach to engage the right internal stakeholders, assess risk and financial impact, and confirm readiness to pursue an opportunity from RFP intake through signature.

Purpose

Bring the right internal stakeholders together at the right time to evaluate the opportunity, accept risks, validate financial impact, and ensure the organization is aligned before committing resources and moving forward.



Color Team Roles and Key Review Focus by Stage

Key: ● Primary ● Support ○ Informed (as needed) — Not involved

Color Team	Primary Focus	1. Intake & Initial Assessment	2. Opportunity Evaluation	3. Solution Development & Internal Review	4. Final Review & Approval to Submit	5. Negotiation & Final Review	6. Signature & Handoff
Sales	Opportunity strategy, win strategy, customer engagement, solution fit	●	●	●	●	●	○
Program Management	Delivery feasibility, resource planning, implementation approach, ongoing support	●	●	●	○	○	●
Finance	Financial viability, pricing, margin analysis, cost structure, contract value thresholds	○	●	●	●	●	○
Legal	Contract terms, risk review, redlines, negotiation support, signature authority	○	●	●	●	●	●
Compliance	Regulatory, customer, ethical, and policy requirements, data security, export controls	○	●	●	○	●	○

Contract Value–Driven Involvement

Contract Value (Example)	Required Internal Reviewers (at minimum)	Additional Reviewers (as needed)	Typical Considerations
<\$X	Sales, Program Management	—	Low complexity, standard terms, routine execution
\$X – \$Y	Sales, Finance, Program Management, Legal (as needed)	Compliance (as needed)	Moderate complexity, non-standard terms, moderate risk
>\$Y	Sales, Finance, Legal, Compliance, Program Management	Executive Leadership (as required)	High contract value, high risk, strategic customer, regulatory requirements, or reputational impact

Color Team Definitions

Sales	Owns customer strategy, solution approach, and win plan.
Program Management	Validates delivery feasibility, resources, and implementation.
Finance	Assesses financial viability, pricing, margin, and contract value.
Legal	Reviews and negotiates contract terms and accepts legal risk.
Compliance	Confirms regulatory, policy, and ethical requirements.